

Journal Broken Links — Verification for Review

Source page: [/journal.html](#) | Repo: [cxchajon/website-fish-keeper](#) | Branch: [claude/journal-broken-links-verify-ectuda](#) | Verified 2026-08-01. Verification pass only — no links were changed.

Headline findings

- **There are 15 broken entry links, not 14.** The earlier audit undercounted by one. All 15 literal hrefs are listed in the table below.
- **Every one of the 15 has matching content in the JSON data layer.** Each URL resolves to an entry in `/data/journal/YYYY-MM.json` whose title matches the anchor text exactly. **None of the 15 is safe to delete outright** — deleting the links would orphan real, published content.
- **No `/journal/2026-*.html` file exists anywhere in the repo**, under any name or path. Git history confirms these files were never created and never deleted — so unlike the `sump-lessons` typo, this is not a misspelled path pointing at a real file.
- **The full text of all 15 entries is already inline on `/journal.html` itself.** Each entry is a complete static `<article>` block with body copy, bullets and tags. The links point from an entry card to a detail page that was never built.

Note on the “Live status” column

Live HTTP status could not be measured from this session. This environment's network policy refuses all outbound connections to `thetankguide.com` — the proxy gateway answers 403 to the CONNECT tunnel before any request reaches the origin. A known-good control URL (`/journal/2025-11.html`) returned the identical 403, confirming the block is the sandbox and not the site. The status shown is therefore **inferred from the deployed source**, and is stated as such rather than as a measurement:

- No matching file exists in the repo, which is what is published at the domain root.
- `_redirects` contains no rule matching `/journal/*` — the only journal rule is `/journal-dashboard.html → /journal.html 301`. Nothing rewrites or redirects these paths.
- With no file and no rule, the host serves its 404 handler. Expected result: **404, no redirect**, for all 15.

Recommended manual check: open two or three of the plain-text URLs below on a phone or any unrestricted network to confirm the 404 before acting.

Link-by-link verification (newest first)

#	URL	Live status	Repo file found?	JSON entry found?	Finding
1	<code>/journal/2026-07-balance-experiment-journal-recap.html</code>	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES <code>data/journal/2026-07.json</code> date <code>2026-07</code> title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on <code>/journal.html</code> ; no destination page exists
2	<code>/journal/2026-06-balance-experiment-journal-recap.html</code>	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES <code>data/journal/2026-06.json</code> date <code>2026-06</code> title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on <code>/journal.html</code> ; no destination page exists
3	<code>/journal/2026-05-balance-experiment-phase-2-synopsis.html</code>	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES <code>data/journal/2026-05.json</code> date <code>2026-05</code> title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on <code>/journal.html</code> ; no destination page exists
4	<code>/journal/2026-04-11-maintenance-reset-nitrate-experiment-day-0.html</code>	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES <code>data/journal/2026-04.json</code> date <code>2026-04-11</code> title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on <code>/journal.html</code> ; no destination page exists
5	<code>/journal/2026-04-balance-experiment-phase-1-phase-2.html</code>	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES <code>data/journal/2026-04.json</code> date <code>2026-04</code> title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on <code>/journal.html</code> ; no destination page exists

#	URL	Live status	Repo file found?	JSON entry found?	Finding
6	/journal/2026-03-31-deep-maintenance-check-valve-fix.html	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES data/journal/2026-03.json date 2026-03-31 title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on /journal.html; no destination page exists
7	/journal/2026-03-22-maintenance-bba-experiment-prep.html	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES data/journal/2026-03.json date 2026-03-22 title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on /journal.html; no destination page exists
8	/journal/2026-03-14-moss-transfer-pothos-rotation.html	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES data/journal/2026-03.json date 2026-03-14 title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on /journal.html; no destination page exists
9	/journal/2026-03-03-delayed-maintenance-moss-growth-update.html	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES data/journal/2026-03.json date 2026-03-03 title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on /journal.html; no destination page exists
10	/journal/2026-03-sump-overflow-troubleshooting.html	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES data/journal/2026-03.json date 2026-03 title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on /journal.html; no destination page exists
11	/journal/2026-02-16-post-incident-stabilization-water-change.html	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES data/journal/2026-02.json date 2026-02-16 title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on /journal.html; no destination page exists
12	/journal/2026-02-10-post-maintenance-loss-system-stabilization.html	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES data/journal/2026-02.json date 2026-02-10 title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on /journal.html; no destination page exists
13	/journal/2026-01-31-weekly-maintenance-media-replacement.html	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES data/journal/2026-01.json date 2026-01-31 title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on /journal.html; no destination page exists
14	/journal/2026-01-26-weekly-maintenance-pothos-trim.html	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES data/journal/2026-01.json date 2026-01-26 title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on /journal.html; no destination page exists
15	/journal/2026-01-18-weekly-maintenance-light-replanting.html	404 (inferred) no redirect not measurable from session	NO no file under any path/name; never in git history	YES data/journal/2026-01.json date 2026-01-18 title matches anchor exactly	Content exists, needs relinking entry lives in JSON data layer and inline on /journal.html; no destination page exists

Supporting evidence & things worth a second look

• **Link count.** `grep -o 'href="/journal/2026-[^\"]*"' journal.html | sort -u` returns 15 unique hrefs (journal.html lines 237, 681, 763, 818, 953, 1082, 1146, 1243, 1287, 1334, 1390, 1444, 1496, 1529, 1562).

- **An existing page pattern already fits.** `/journal/2025-10.html` and `/journal/2025-11.html` are *monthly archive* pages that fetch `/data/journal/YYYY-MM.json` at runtime. The 2026 month JSON files (2026-01 through 2026-07) all exist, but no 2026 archive pages were ever built to consume them. The data is published and reachable; only the pages are missing.
- **`/journal.html` is fully static.** Despite the JSON-driven archive pattern elsewhere, `journal.html` itself does no fetch — every 2026 entry is hardcoded HTML on the page. That is why the content is visible to readers even though every entry link 404s.
- **`data/journal/index.json` is stale.** It lists only 2026-04 through 2025-09 and omits 2026-05, 2026-06 and 2026-07, even though those month files exist. Anything that reads the index will miss the three newest months.
- **`scripts/generate-journal-months.mjs` is broken.** It reads `data/journal.json` expecting an array of entries, but that file is now a chart-data object (nitrate/dosing/maintenance for Oct–Nov 2025) and the script would throw on it. It also skips any month-only date such as 2026-07, since it requires a full YYYY-MM-DD. The real master list now appears to be `data/journal.csv` (97 entries).
- **Possible column misalignment in `data/journal.csv`.** Four of the 15 URLs (2026-04, 05, 06, 07) appear in the CSV's final column — but that column's header is `Image`, and every other row using it holds an actual image path (e.g. `assets/images/mts-on-strainer-2025-11-03.jpg`). Either a `link/slug` column is missing from the header, or those four URLs were written into the wrong field. Worth checking before any generator is re-run against this CSV.
- **Sitemap is consistent with the 404s.** `sitemap.xml` lists only the 2025 journal pages; none of the 15 broken URLs is submitted for indexing, so the SEO exposure is internal link equity rather than crawl errors on submitted URLs.

What “needs relinking” would mean here (for your decision — nothing was changed)

- **Option A — unwrap the anchors.** The entry text is already fully rendered on `/journal.html`, so removing just the `<a href>` wrapper from each `<h3>` keeps every heading and all content intact and eliminates all 15 404s. Smallest change; loses per-entry permalinks.
- **Option B — build the 2026 monthly archive pages.** Clone the existing `/journal/2025-11.html` pattern for 2026-01 through 2026-07 (the JSON already exists) and point each entry link at its month page plus an anchor. Preserves linkability and matches how the rest of the journal already works.
- **Option C — author 15 per-entry pages.** Matches the current hrefs exactly, but it is 15 new pages of duplicate content against copy that already lives on `/journal.html`.
- **Not recommended: deleting the links.** Under the audit's own criteria none of the 15 qualifies as “safe to delete” — every one has a real, matching entry in the data layer.

Plain-text URL list (copy/paste for manual checking)

<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-07-balance-experiment-journal-recap.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-06-balance-experiment-journal-recap.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-05-balance-experiment-phase-2-synopsis.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-04-11-maintenance-reset-nitrate-experiment-day-0.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-04-balance-experiment-phase-1-phase-2.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-03-31-deep-maintenance-check-valve-fix.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-03-22-maintenance-bba-experiment-prep.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-03-14-moss-transfer-pothos-rotation.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-03-03-delayed-maintenance-moss-growth-update.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-03-sump-overflow-troubleshooting.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-02-16-post-incident-stabilization-water-change.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-02-10-post-maintenance-loss-system-stabilization.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-01-31-weekly-maintenance-media-replacement.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-01-26-weekly-maintenance-pothos-trim.html>
<https://thetankguide.com/journal/2026-01-18-weekly-maintenance-light-replanting.html>